



EasyPeasy 1.6 final released

Only a week after the RC comes the final release of version 1.6 of EasyPeasy, a Linux distribution aimed at netbooks. Originally called “Ubuntu-eee” until Canonical objected, it has in the past focused on the ASUS Eee PC, but it also supports a number of other netbook devices.



Based on Ubuntu 10.04 “Lucid Lynx”, EasyPeasy 1.6 features a “brand new interface” and includes a new boot system with new artwork, using Plymouth. HAL (hardware abstraction layer) is no longer used during boot or resume, resulting in speed gains of up to 25 per cent. The release includes a number of updated packages,

the open-source Nouveau driver for nVidia graphics hardware, and Lucid’s MeMenu—integration with social networks like Twitter, identi.ca and Facebook. More at: <http://goo.gl/L529>

Ubuntu Unity and Light

At the recent Ubuntu Developers Summit, Mark Shuttleworth presented Ubuntu “Light”, an instantly-on-and-connected netbook and desktop version of the distro, which is optimised for dual-boot scenarios, and “Unity”, a new light-weight interface that will be included in Ubuntu Light and Ubuntu Netbook Edition.

Ubuntu Light will be distributed as a secondary OS on computers with Windows as the primary OS. Mainly aimed at OEMs, it will be optimised for each OEM’s specific hardware, to ensure fastest possible boot-up for that platform—and hence will not be available for download from the Ubuntu website.

The new Unity UI for GNOME is optimised for netbooks, and has:

- Stress on touch as a first-class input method to launch and switch between applications.
- A slightly oversized panel (more touch-friendly) as an application launcher dock at the left of the screen. The bottom panel will be dropped.
- Use of the global menu concept for the top-panel: window title bars will appear on the top GNOME panel, instead of on the window itself as in Mac OS X.

These tweaks intend to maximise available vertical space, given the widespread use of wide-screen monitors, and instead use more horizontal space for always-displayed UI elements. This is especially with netbooks in mind, where screen real estate is precious.

LifeHacker has a review at <http://goo.gl/rQz5> and you can, if interested, try out Unity on Lucid, with these instructions: <http://goo.gl/TMio>



RHEL 3 and CentOS 3 end-of-life, RHEL 6 beta

Red Hat has published a reminder that version 3 of Red Hat Enterprise Linux reaches its end-of-life (EOL) on the 31st of October, 2010. After that date, no further updates, including security updates and critical fixes, will be available for RHEL 3. The EOL date will also affect CentOS 3, which is based on the RHEL 3 source.

More at: <http://goo.gl/CnJS>

Meanwhile, the company’s next major release, RHEL 6, is currently in beta, and The Register has a short review at <http://goo.gl/6lgl>. RHEL 6 drops the Xen virtualisation platform, and focuses on KVM, adding a number of performance and hardware support upgrades. New for virtual guests is the SELinux sandbox feature (which can be applied to just about any untrusted code you’d like to execute in an isolated environment, but now works with guest machines). Along with better multi-core support (in theory, RHEL could use 64,000 cores in a single system image!) comes support for new chip architectures including Intel’s Xeon 5600 and 7500, and the Power7 from IBM.

